

Review Report of paper: BLC-2026-04-0069 (IET Blockchain Wiley)

Paper title: Cryptographic Chain-of-Custody for Last-Mile Parcel Delivery: A Blockchain–IoT System Architecture with Discrete-Event Simulation Evaluation.

Final decision: **Accept after significant revision.**

Overall Comments:

- 1- The paper is relatively short with abbreviated details for a journal submission, yet the topic is promising and a simulation was done; hence, it deserves a second round to complete the missing.
- 2- There is a very recent (Feb 2026) Wiley Sustainable Development article on nearly the same topic (<https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1002/sd.70745>). Hence, this article must maintain at least a comparable depth (level of details), but from a blockchain oriented perspective; I believe a researcher in the field should find the 2 papers completing each other giving a whole picture view on the topic.
- 3- In general, the paper should use the related references in the above paper [Hamdan et al. (2023), Zhu et al. (2022, 2024), Monoarfa et al. (2024), and Vasić et al. (2024)] and in the newest reference it cites ([33] science direct 9/2025) to write a more detailed related work section; the same applies to Table1 in the paper. Also, elaborate more on the impact of the used blockchain kind (ex.: public vs private/consortium, Ethereum vs. Hyperledger Fabric, are there existing real-life examples).
- 4- Finally, more line-by-line are added to the manuscript pdf in red & green.

Extra References found (from the blockchain side) to help the author:

2018: <https://scet.berkeley.edu/blockchain-technology-beyond-cryptocurrencies-case-1-future-last-mile-delivery/>

2026: <https://www.leangroup.com/resources/how-blockchain-and-iot-are-revolutionizing-supply-chain-transparency>

2021: <https://ruralhandmade.com/blog/iot-revolutionizing-cross-border-supply-chains-enhancing>

Course or thesis in 2022/2023:

https://tesi.luiss.it/36467/1/747921_FRANCESANGELI_VITTORIA.pdf

IFAC 2022 paper: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2405896322021334>

Finally, AI link (should have been a starting point for the author, but no problem; just reach your best perfection) <https://share.google/aimode/b2es3rwLWwGdoCeaW>

